

Baby Bottle Refusal Return To Work — Action Checklist

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ASSESS REFUSAL PATTERNS

- ☐ **Observe whether your baby gags or chokes when milk flows to confirm a flow mismatch as the root cause of refusal.:** Observe whether your baby gags or chokes when milk flows to confirm a flow mismatch as the root cause of refusal.
- ☐ **Notice if your baby accepts bottles from others but refuses when you hold the bottle, which points to an association problem rather than a mechanical issue.:** Notice if your baby accepts bottles from others but refuses when you hold the bottle, which points to an association problem rather than a mechanical issue.
- ☐ **Watch for complete refusal with crying and screaming, which signals anxiety or overwhelm that requires a gentler approach.:** Watch for complete refusal with crying and screaming, which signals anxiety or overwhelm that requires a gentler approach.
- ☐ **Keep a simple log of each feeding attempt including who offered, your baby's state, and the response to identify patterns over the two weeks.:** Keep a simple log of each feeding attempt including who offered, your baby's state, and the response to identify patterns over the two weeks.

MASTER BOTTLE TECHNIQUE

- ☐ **Start every bottle introduction with the slowest flow nipple available to match your breast's natural letdown pace for your baby.:** Start every bottle introduction with the slowest flow nipple available to match your breast's natural letdown pace for your baby.
- ☐ **Dip the bottle nipple in expressed breast milk and let your baby lick and smell it before attempting to feed, using scent to bridge the gap.:** Dip the bottle nipple in expressed breast milk and let your baby lick and smell it before attempting to feed, using scent to bridge the gap.
- ☐ **Offer the bottle when your baby is slightly hungry but not desperate, since a frantic baby is too stressed to learn something new.:** Offer the bottle when your baby is slightly hungry but not desperate, since a frantic baby is too stressed to learn something new.

- ☐ **Use paced bottle feeding by holding your baby upright and keeping the bottle horizontal to slow the flow and mimic breastfeeding rhythms.:** Use paced bottle feeding by holding your baby upright and keeping the bottle horizontal to slow the flow and mimic breastfeeding rhythms.

SELECT RIGHT EQUIPMENT

- ☐ **Leave the house entirely during bottle attempts so your baby cannot hold out for the breast when you're the one holding the bottle.:** Leave the house entirely during bottle attempts so your baby cannot hold out for the breast when you're the one holding the bottle.
- ☐ **Try offering the bottle when your baby is drowsy or just waking, since babies in this state are more receptive to new feeding methods.:** Try offering the bottle when your baby is drowsy or just waking, since babies in this state are more receptive to new feeding methods.
- ☐ **Introduce bottles designed specifically for breastfed babies with wide, breast-shaped nipples and slow-flow settings from Lansinoh, Medela, or Tommee Tippee.:** Introduce bottles designed specifically for breastfed babies with wide, breast-shaped nipples and slow-flow settings from Lansinoh, Medela, or Tommee Tippee.
- ☐ **Test at least two or three different bottle brands if your baby refuses the first option, since every baby has individual preferences for nipple shape.:** Test at least two or three different bottle brands if your baby refuses the first option, since every baby has individual preferences for nipple shape.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.